

Self-learning Session

Table of Contents

Introduction..... 3

From Experience to Growth..... 3

The Knowing-Doing Gap 4

Identifying Learning Gaps..... 4

Finding Reliable Learning Resources 5

Learning Through Reflection 6

Continuous Self-Learning 7

Key Takeaways 7

Recall 8

References..... 8

Learning Objectives

- At the end of the session participants will be able to:
- Apply self-directed learning strategies to identify reliable learning resources.
 - Apply reflection techniques to learn from leadership experiences.

Introduction

Leadership is not defined by the number of experiences we have, but by our ability to learn from experiences. Every challenge, project, or interaction provides an opportunity to develop new knowledge and improve future performance.



Self-learning, also known as **Self-Directed Learning (SDL)**, is the process of taking responsibility for one's own learning by identifying learning needs, seeking reliable resources, applying new knowledge, and reflecting on experiences. This continuous process enables leaders to adapt to change, solve problems effectively, and grow throughout their leadership journey.

From Experience to Growth

Experience is often considered one of the greatest teachers. However, experience alone does not always lead to improvement. Some leaders become more effective after every challenge, while others continue making the same mistakes despite having similar experiences.



The difference lies in **how they learn from those experiences**. Growth occurs when individuals actively reflect on their actions, recognize areas for improvement, seek new knowledge, and apply what they have learned in future situations.



Key Points

Knowledge alone does not improve performance. Real growth occurs when learning is consistently applied in real situations.



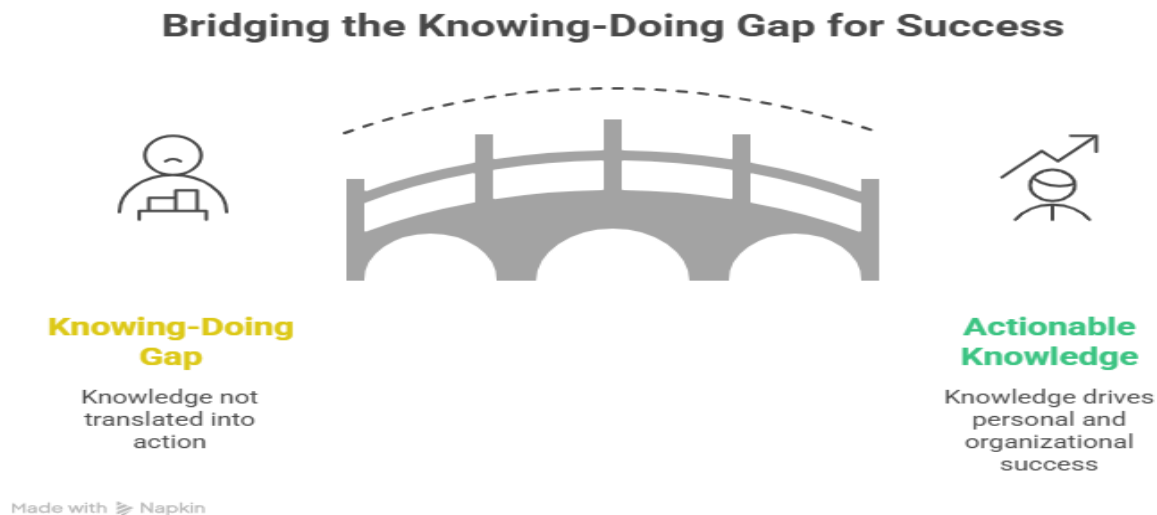
Personal Reflection

What prevented you from putting your knowledge into practice?

The Knowing-Doing Gap

One common reason why people fail to improve is the **Knowing-Doing Gap**, which refers to the difference between knowing what should be done and consistently applying that knowledge in practice.

Many individuals understand leadership concepts but struggle to implement them in real situations. This gap may result from relying on old habits, avoiding difficult situations, or failing to reflect on previous experiences.



Example

A leader understands the importance of providing constructive feedback but avoids difficult conversations with team members. Although the knowledge exists, it has not been translated into action.

Recognizing this gap is the first step toward continuous learning because it encourages leaders to focus not only on acquiring knowledge but also on applying it effectively.

Identifying Learning Gaps

Once leaders recognize that knowledge alone is not enough, the next step is identifying **what they still need to learn**.

A **Learning Gap** is the difference between an individual's current knowledge or skills and those required to perform effectively in a specific situation. Identifying these gaps helps learners focus their efforts on developing the competencies that will have the greatest impact on their performance.

Learning gaps can be identified by asking questions such as:



- What do I already know?
- What challenge am I facing?
- What knowledge or skill is missing?
- What do I need to learn to improve?

Leaders can also identify learning gaps through:

- Reflection after completing a task.
- Feedback from peers or team leaders.
- Performance results.
- Challenges and failures.

Example

After facilitating a meeting, a leader realizes that managing discussions was more difficult than expected. This experience highlights a learning gap in meeting facilitation and communication skills.



Key Points

Identifying learning gaps helps leaders focus on the knowledge and skills that will have the greatest impact on their performance.



Personal Reflection

How did you identify that this is an area for development?

Finding Reliable Learning Resources

After identifying a learning gap, the next step is choosing appropriate learning resources.

Today, information is available through books, articles, online courses, AI tools, podcasts, videos, and professional communities. While these resources provide valuable learning opportunities, not all of them are equally reliable. Effective self-directed learners evaluate the quality of information before using it to make decisions or develop new skills.



One commonly used method is the, which evaluates information based on five criteria:

Currency Is the information current and up to date?

Relevance Does it address the learning need?

Authority Is the author or organization qualified?

Accuracy Is the information supported by evidence?

Purpose Why was the information created?

Using these criteria helps learners select trustworthy sources and make informed learning decisions.

Learning Through Reflection

Learning is most effective when experiences are followed by reflection. Reflection enables leaders to analyze their actions, understand the reasons behind outcomes, and identify improvements for future situations.



A widely recognized model for learning from experience is **Kolb's Experiential Learning Cycle**, which consists of four stages:

Concrete Experience

Participating in a real situation or completing a task.

Reflective Observation

Thinking critically about what happened and why.

Abstract Conceptualization

Connecting the experience with concepts, theories, or lessons learned.

Active Experimentation

Applying those lessons in future situations.

Example

After completing an event, a team reviews what worked well, identifies areas for improvement, and applies these lessons when planning the next event.

Reflection transforms experiences into meaningful learning opportunities and supports continuous improvement.



Key Points

Reflection transforms experiences into meaningful learning by helping leaders understand what happened and how to improve future performance.

Continuous Self-Learning

Self-learning is a continuous cycle rather than a one-time activity. Every leadership experience creates an opportunity to learn, improve, and prepare for future challenges.



An effective learning process can be summarized as follows:

Reflect → Identify the Learning Gap → Find Reliable Resources → Apply Learning → Reflect Again

By repeating this cycle, leaders continuously strengthen their knowledge, improve their skills, and become more adaptable in different leadership situations.



Personal Reflection

After completing a task or event, do you usually take time to reflect on your performance? Why or why not?

Key Takeaways

- Self-learning is the ability to take responsibility for your own development.
- Experience alone does not guarantee improvement; learning comes from reflection and application.
- Identifying learning gaps helps focus learning efforts on the most important areas.
- Reliable resources support informed decisions and effective learning.
- Continuous reflection enables leaders to learn from every experience and improve over time.

Recall

1. What do you think prevented you from turning knowledge into action?

.....

.....

.....

2. Which question is related to the "Authority" criterion in the CRAAP Test?

- a. Is the information up to date
- b. Why was this information created
- c. Is the author qualified to discuss this topic

3. True & False

The Knowing-Doing Gap refers to the difference between what people know and what they actually apply.

a. True

b. false

References

<https://infed.org/mobi/malcolm-knowles-informal-adult-education-self-direction-and-andragogy/>

<https://www.gsb.stanford.edu/insights/knowning-doing-gap>

<https://library.csuchico.edu/sites/default/files/craap-test.pdf>

<https://www.simplypsychology.org/learning-kolb.html>